

be considered black. Raising that threshold will darken more areas of the image, so you can use this to get a high-contrast effect without actually boosting the lighter areas of the image.

Brightness, Contrast:

In Photoshop CS3, Brightness actually works differently from previous versions—instead of just adding white to the image, Brightness adjusts highlights and shadows so that neither ends up swallowing the entire image. The contrast slider, however, works exactly as you would expect it to.

Clarity:

This slider adds definition to the edges in your photo to give you crisper images.

Saturation:

This slider adjusts the intensity of all colours in the image.

Vibrance:

This slider adjusts saturation too, but it also prevents colours from getting too saturated.

When you're done with basic adjustments, you can make finer tweaks to your image using Tone Curves.

The Tone Curve Tab

This is a little difficult to understand, but with a little experimentation, you can still get the effect you desire.

The horizontal axis of the graph represents the original tones of your photo, with the darkest on the left and getting lighter towards the right. The vertical axis represents the tone values after you've had your way with them. When the tone curve is a straight, 45-degree line, it means that the output image is the same as the input. Moving a point upward brightens the corresponding output, and moving it downward darkens it. You can use the sliders under Parametric to see the effect